

28 Million Documents and Counting

Digital Preservation and Corporate Accountability at the UCSF Industry Documents Library

The Industry Documents Library

The Industry Documents Library (IDL) at the University of California San Francisco (UCSF) is a digital archive of documents which were publicly released from industries that influence public health.

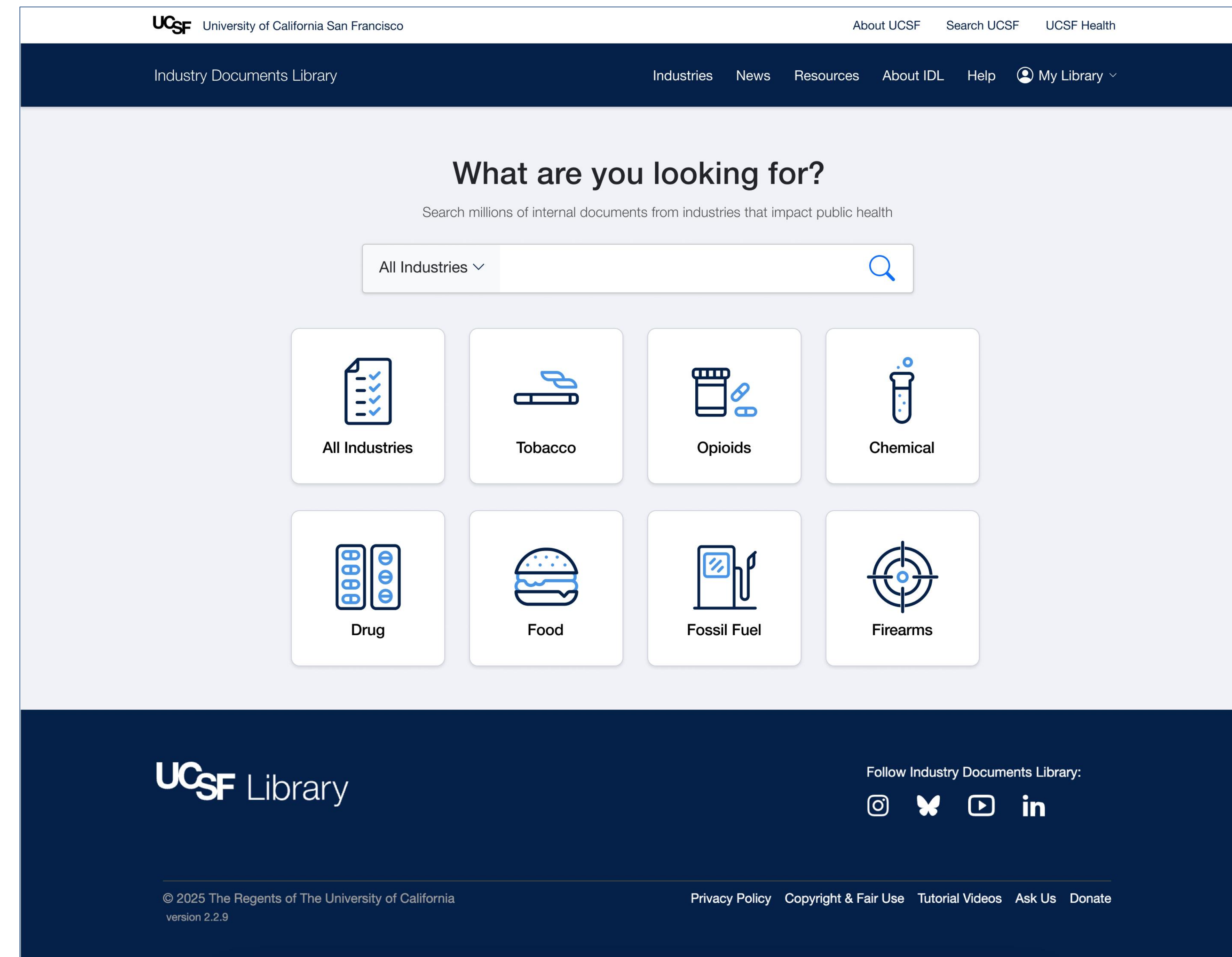
- Preserves millions of documents made public in historic litigation against the **tobacco industry** since 2002.
- Houses the **UCSF-JHU Opioid Industry Documents Archive**.
- Includes documents publicly disclosed from the **drug, chemical, food, fossil fuel, and firearms** industries.
- Supported by **8 FTE staff**.
- **Audience** includes academics, legal professionals, public health experts, journalists, students, educators, community advocates, and the public.
- Cited in over **1,200 publications** that informed public health policy, including the U.S. Family Smoking and Tobacco Prevention Act and the World Health Organization's Framework Convention on Tobacco Control.

Unique Challenges

The IDL became a fully digital archive as digital preservation standards and best practices were still emerging. As the archive has grown, preservation practices have been integrated into established workflows while balancing scale, complexity, and time-sensitive public access.

- **High volume:** Typically releases more than **200,000 public documents** per month.
- **Diverse formats:** Records include email, memos, legal documents, images, marketing materials, presentations, invoices, Slack messages, spreadsheets, audio, and video.
- **Derivatives:** Most records are transformed during legal discovery before they reach the IDL.
- **Mixed file types:** Collections contain both PDF derivatives and native file formats.
- **Inherited metadata:** Item-level metadata is available but largely originates from legal processing workflows.
- **Access vs. preservation:** Legal settlements mandate timely public access, making it challenging to incorporate additional preservation steps into existing workflows.

28 million documents / 150 million pages / 61 TB



How does the IDL prioritize preservation of millions of documents, while also meeting its public access mandate?

Accept the Realities of Cloud-Based Storage

The IDL uses cloud storage to balance **rapid public access, preservation, scalability, and cost** across millions of documents.

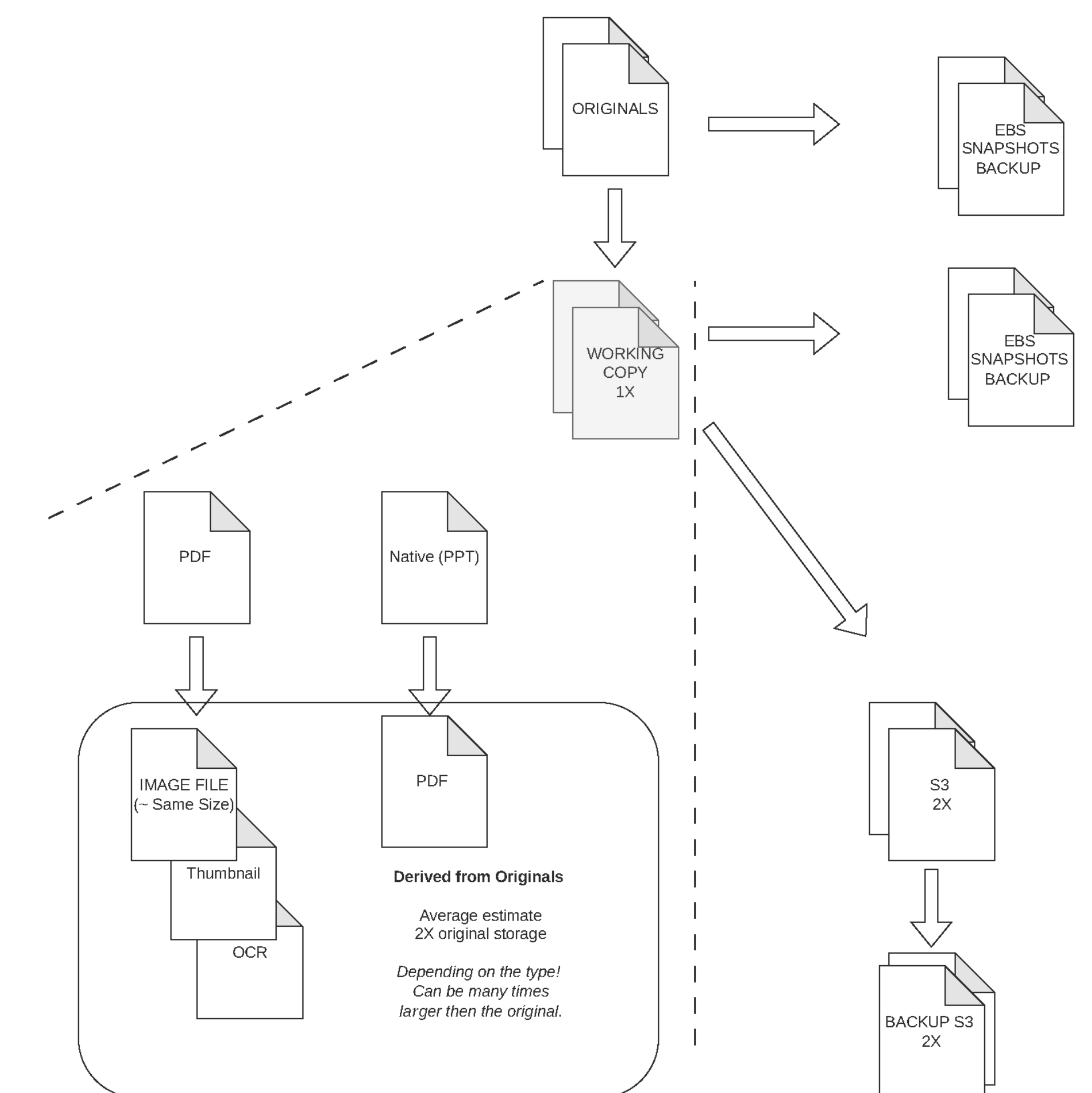
- **Proven infrastructure:** IDL migrated to AWS in **2015**, providing more than a decade of reliable cloud-based access.
- **Redundant access copies:** DIPs are stored in AWS S3 for public access and backed up monthly to a **separate AWS region**.
- **Additional redundancy:** DIPs are also deposited in IDL's **Open Data Registry**, hosted in a third AWS region.
- **Scalable and affordable:** IDL acquired more than **6 million documents in the past two years**. Cloud storage helps accommodate continued growth while keeping long-term costs manageable.
- **AV redundancy:** Audio and video files are co-preserved through the Internet Archive while also maintained in IDL's S3 storage and Solr index.
- **Future holds more cloud storage:** To diversify preservation, AIPs will include unredacted originals (when available), extracted text, and metadata. The IDL recently set up additional cloud storage (Microsoft Azure) through UCSF IT, providing institution-controlled preservation storage independent of AWS.

Learn from the Legal Process

- Cloud-based legal e-Discovery software supports **rapid appraisal** of millions of documents and includes AI-assisted tools for reviewing and **redacting protected information**.

Data Management

- Custom **open-source infrastructure** using MariaDB, Apache Solr, Payload CMS.
- Supports metadata management, filename normalization, OCR creation, checksum generation and validation, and metadata mapping.
- SIPs received on encrypted **hard drives**.
- AIPs saved to **institutional storage** (MS Azure).
- DIPs stored and made public through **AWS servers**.



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UCSF Library